



Course Name

NIGERIAN PEOPLE'S & CULTURE

Topic: Nigerian People's & Culture

WEEK 1

IN SUMMARY

In week 1, you learned about key concepts in our course: culture, society, and nation-building. Culture, a complex system, encompasses traditional behaviours, beliefs, practises, and values with three vital components: technological, sociological, and ideological. Society was categorised into communal and associational forms, highlighting differences in labour, social interactions, and traditions. You also explored the historical emergence of society, Karl Marx's communist vision, and the impact of colonialism on Nigerian governance, culture, and families. Lastly, you were introduced to nation-building, emphasising resource mobilisation for socio-political development and national identity creation. You examined Nigeria's challenges in achieving national integration and government initiatives to foster it. This course provides a strong foundation for understanding Nigerian culture, society, nation-building, and integration.



BULLET POINT SUMMARY

- Culture is a complex concept encompassing traditional behaviours, beliefs, practises, and values.
- Culture has three fundamental components: technological (material culture), sociological (institutions and norms), and ideological (beliefs and values).
- Society can be categorised into communal and associational forms, differing in division of labour, social interactions, and traditions.
- Karl Marx envisioned a communist society with collective ownership of means of production and wealth distribution.
- Functionalism views society as an organism where each component plays a crucial role.
- Colonialism had significant impacts on African societies, altering governance, culture, and family structures.
- Nation-building involves mobilising resources for socio-economic and political development and constructing a national identity, with challenges to achieving national integration.



CASE STUDY

Title: Challenges and Progress in Nation Building and National Integration: A Case Study of Nigeria

Introduction: Nigeria, a diverse nation, faces hurdles in its nation-building journey due to its ethnic diversity. This case study explores Nigeria's history, challenges, and government interventions in nation building and national integration.

Objective: Analyse Nigeria's nation building and national integration, considering historical events, conflicts, and government policies. Evaluate the effectiveness of government initiatives in promoting unity.

Methods: Methods include historical analysis, document review, case studies, government policy evaluation, surveys/interviews, and comparative analysis. These approaches aim to analyse Nigeria's nation-building and integration challenges effectively.

QUESTIONS TO PONDER

- Can you visualise the intricate web of cultural elements that make up a society, considering the multifaceted aspects of culture, including traditions, beliefs, and practises?
- Think of the impact of colonialism on societies like pre-colonial Yoruba communities. How did the introduction of new systems and changes in family dynamics reshape their way of life and social structures?
- Explain why the concept of national integration is essential for a diverse country like Nigeria. How do you think historical events and government policies have influenced the nation's journey towards integration and unity?



SKILLS AND COMPETENCIES YOU HAVE ACQUIRED AFTER THIS LESSON

Cultural awareness, historical awareness, sociological understanding, interdisciplinary thinking, and communication skills

PERSONAL REFLECTION

How has your own cultural background and upbringing influenced your perspective on society and nation-building?